

Title

Combined traditional exercise and cognitive training improves symptom severity and functioning in hospitalized patients with schizophrenia

Abstract

Background: Adjunctive therapies targeting both motor and cognitive domains may enhance outcomes in schizophrenia beyond pharmacotherapy alone. **Objective:** To evaluate whether combining Baduanjin practice with computerized cognitive remediation produces greater benefits than cognitive training without movement intervention. **Methods:** A total of 120 hospitalized schizophrenia patients (mean age 44 years; 67% male) were randomized to either combined therapy (n=60) or cognitive remediation only (n=60). Sessions occurred 5 days per week for 8 weeks. Outcome measures included PANSS (psychiatric symptoms), NCSE (cognition), SSPI (social functioning), and SQLS (quality of life). **Results:** At 8 weeks, the combined-treatment group showed greater reduction in PANSS total scores (mean reduction 14.2 points versus 8.7 points, $P = 0.003$). Improvements in negative symptom subscales were particularly pronounced ($P = 0.001$). Cognitive performance and social functioning indices also favored the combined approach (all $P < 0.05$). No serious adverse events occurred in either group. **Conclusion:** Addition of Baduanjin to cognitive remediation significantly enhances therapeutic benefit for psychiatric symptoms and functional domains in schizophrenia.